Statement

Sensitive

Statement in the matter of R v Vida Reid

Name	Joy Valerie Pickering
Occupation	Host Family
Address	Known to National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS)
Date	13 October 2022

STATES:

1. This statement made by me accurately sets out the evidence that I would be prepared, if necessary, to give in court as a witness.

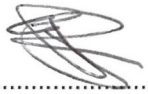
2. My full name is Joy Valerie Pickering and I am 60 years of age.

3. My residential address is known to the National Disability Insurance Scheme.

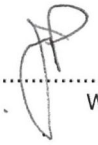
4. I am the nominee for Benjamin Dines who is my son. Ben's Participant number is 430800637. Ben has had a plan under the NDIS since 2016. His disabilities include an acquired brain injury, diabetes, legally blind in one eye and slurred speech as a result of a motor car accident. Ben currently receives over night care and day support workers, speech therapy, and psychological therapy.

5. I have known Terri Roberts since 2010 and first meet her through my family. Terri started working for a company called Forward Focus Group (FFG). This company was providing various services under the NDIS. In about October 2021, I spoke to Terri about getting support coordination services for Ben through FFG.

6. Terri prepared a service agreement between me as Ben's nominee, and FFG for the provision of support coordination. I signed this service agreement with FFG on Ben's behalf.



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Signature



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Witness

7. I was due to have a meeting with Terri the day after I signed the service agreement in October 2021 to discuss Ben's plan funding. This meeting was to take place at the offices of a company called Enable who are NDIS service providers. The meeting also involved a representative of the NDIS whose name I can't remember.

8. Enable were providing supports to Ben at the time, I just needed a support coordinator and that why I engaged FFG. Terri didn't turn up at the office of Enable so we proceeded without her.

9. When Terri didn't turn up at the meeting, I called FFG to speak to her. The phone call was answered by a woman called Vida who told me that Terri no longer worked for them. I later ascertained that her full name was Vida Reid. I rang FFG the same day again still trying to find Terri and spoke to woman who also told me that Terri no longer for FFG.

10. I decided not to proceed with FFG as Terri no longer worked there. Within a two-day period after the meeting with Enable, I was contacted by a woman from FFG who had been assigned by Terri to be Ben's support coordinator. This woman told me FFG could not continue with Ben's services to which I agreed. At that stage, FFG had not provided any services to Ben anyway. FFG did not have a representative in the meeting with Enable and NDIS.

11. On Tuesday the 11 October 2022, I was contacted by Gerard Righetti from Fraud Investigations Team at the NDIA. Gerard told me that FFG had claimed a payment from Ben's plan consisting of 11 hours of household cleaning. I was blown away by this and immediately thought 'That Bitch' referring to Vida.

12. I never got any services from FFG or asked them to provide cleaning for Ben. It was only ever supposed to be a support coordinator which never proceeded anyway.

13. Ben is very neat and tidy and cleans his own house with help from his support workers.

This statement is true to the best of my knowledge and belief. I have made this statement knowing that, if it is tendered in evidence, I will be guilty of a crime if I have wilfully included in the statement anything that I know to be false or that I do not believe is true.

Signature _____
Joy Valerie Pickering

Statement taken and signature witnessed by me about 11.15am on 13 October 2022 at Mandurah Central in Western Australia.

Signature _____
Gerard Righetti
Assistant Director Fraud Investigations